DAILY READER

PARSHAT NOACH

The lifted portion, the chosen covenant, and the bow in the cloud

Thursday, 15 October 2026 · Aliyah 5/7 (Genesis 9:8-9:17) · Daf Bekhorot 27

FROM THE LINKED SOURCES

Tovat hana'ah, argued out

Jev score: 0.61 — Jev 0.61: Shoel uMeshiv's analysis of the daf's sugya

Shoel uMeshiv (Mahadura II 4:121) takes up the daf's exact question — tovat hana'ah in priestly gifts and teruma — and argues it through from the Talmud's own terms. He records learning the sugya on Bekhorot 27 and presses the Tanna's reasoning: why does the baraita speak of the owner's discretion for teruma but not for the priestly gifts of foreleg, jaw, and maw? His answer tracks the Gemara's: teruma's inherent sanctity protects it from being degraded by payment, while the gifts, whose sanctity inheres only in their value, could be mistaken for ordinary food once money changes hands.

The responsum is valuable because it doesn't just cite the daf — it re-derives it. The distinction between sanctity that inheres in the thing itself and sanctity that inheres in its value becomes a portable principle: wherever payment touches the sacred, ask which kind of sanctity you're dealing with.

PARSHA · NOACH

Nullification and remnant

Jev score: 0.53 — Jev 0.53 — below the 0.6 strong-connection bar; offered as a measured parallel, not a claim

The daf rules that teruma from outside the Land, mixed with ordinary produce, is nullified in a mere majority — the sacred dissolves into the many. The flood inverts this logic: the many are destroyed, and the sacred remnant — Noah's household, the animals — is preserved apart from the multitude. Two opposite ways holiness survives mixture: by dissolving, or by being set apart.

Jev graded this 0.53, honestly below the threshold for a strong connection. The other candidates scored lower (divine election of Noah as parallel to tovat hana'ah: 0.24; the Noahide covenant as a lower-bar holiness like teruma outside the Land: 0.31; the flood generation's corruption of boundaries: 0.34). The texts share a vocabulary of sacred and multitude, but the daf's legal mechanics and the parsha's narrative operate at different levels.

Rejected by Jev: divine election parallel (0.24), Noahide covenant parallel (0.31), boundary-corruption parallel (0.34), dignified-offering parallel (0.40), grain-pile/vineyard parallel (0.26)

NEWS CHECK

No genuine connection this week

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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Jev score: 0.00 — Jev rejected all six candidates (0.08–0.24)

Six news stories were tested against the daf's themes — the Riyadh airport strikes, Trump's Ukraine demands, the Iran campaign, the Djibouti boat tragedy, European cost-of-living protests, Australia's post-Bondi measures. Jev scored every proposed link between 0.08 and 0.24. The daf's world of priestly gifts, discretion, and calibrated stringencies simply doesn't meet this week's headlines at any honest level of generality. A section may conclude there is no genuine connection, and this is one.

MAAGARIM · TERUMA

תרומה: 7,198 attestations, from lifting to the priest's portion

The word that carries the daf is תרומה — and Maagarim gives its root as רום, height, elevation: the gloss runs 'ascent, height, exaltation, teruma.' The priestly gift is literally 'that which is lifted up' — the portion elevated out of the pile and set apart. The daf's whole discussion is about what happens after the lifting: who may direct it, who may pay for the right to receive it, and how its sanctity behaves when the pile sits outside the Land.

7,198 attestations make it one of the heavyweight terms of the halakhic lexicon. The semantic journey runs from the physical act — lifting the portion off the threshing floor — to the institutional reality: a gift whose sanctity the Sages could calibrate, lightening it beyond the borders while keeping its name. The elevation stays; the weight changes.

Word data: מפעל המילון ההיסטורי של האקדמיה ללשון העברית — the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language.

929 · I KINGS 8 (CH. 295)

The house filled with cloud

66 verses

Sixty-six verses — the longest chapter so far in Kings, and the theological center of Solomon's reign. The ark is brought up from the City of David amid sacrifices 'too many to count,' the priests withdraw, and the cloud fills the house: 'the priests could not stand to minister because of the cloud, for the glory of the LORD filled the house of the LORD.' Presence, not architecture, is what makes it a temple.

Solomon's prayer (verses 22–53) is one of the longest in Tanakh, and its most striking move is the tension it holds open: 'Behold, heaven and the highest heaven cannot contain You — how much less this house that I have built!' The Temple is simultaneously the place where God's name dwells and the place that cannot contain Him. Every petition that follows — for drought, defeat, plague, exile — is routed through this building: 'hear in heaven Your dwelling place.'

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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Rashi, unusually terse here (two glosses, both on verse 1), clarifies the procession's personnel and the ark's journey from Obed-edom's house. Metzudat David notes the timing — 'when all the work of building was complete.' Radak traces the ark's route. The commentators are sparse because the chapter's drama is in its structure: seven petitions, each ending 'hear and forgive,' building to the dedication's climax in fire and feast.

The chapter's final movement is Solomon's blessing and the fourteen days of celebration — the only festival in Tanakh that runs two full weeks. The house is full; the cloud has lifted enough for the priests to stand; the people go home 'joyful and glad of heart.'

MISHNAH YOMI · OHOLOT 10:1-2

The hatchway in the roof

2 mishnayot

Oholot 10:1

אֲרֻבָּה שֶׁהִיא בְתוֹךְ הַבַּיִת וְיֵשׁ בָּהּ פּוֹתֵחַ טָפַח, טֻמְאָה בַבַּיִת, כְּנֶגֶד אֲרֻבָּה טָהוֹר. טֻמְאָה כְנֶגֶד אֲרֻבָּה, הַבַּיִת טָהוֹר. הַטֻּמְאָה בֵּין בַּבַּיִת וּבֵין כְּנֶגֶד אֲרֻבָּה, נָתַן אֶת רַגְלוֹ מִלְמַעְלָן, עֵרֵב אֶת הַטֻּמְאָה. מִקְצָת טֻמְאָה בַבַּיִת וּמִקְצָתָהּ כְּנֶגֶד אֲרֻבָּה, הַבַּיִת טָמֵא, וּכְנֶגֶד הַטֻּמְאָה טָמֵא:

A hatchway in a house, which has an opening of a [square] handbreadth, If there is uncleanness in the house, what is directly [below] the hatchway remains clean. If the uncleanness is directly [below] the hatchway, the house remains clean. If the uncleanness is either in the house or directly [below] the hatchway, and a person placed his foot above [the hatchway] he has combined [with the roof to bring] uncleanness. If part of the uncleanness is in the room and part of it directly [below] the hatchway, the house becomes unclean and what is directly [above] the uncleanness becomes unclean.

Rambam: an ארובה is an opening in the house's roof reaching up to the sky, left uncovered so nothing shades it. Impurity under the roof makes the whole house impure through the ohel — except the spot directly opposite the open hatchway, which stays pure; impurity sitting under the hatchway leaves the whole house pure, since it is not under an ohel. If one sets his hand or foot over the hatchway, he has reached the roof — it is as if there were no hatchway, for a person himself becomes an ohel that conveys impurity (the principle from chapter 6 of this tractate) — that is the meaning of 'he combined the impurity' (ערב את הטמאה). On 'part of the impurity in the house and part opposite the hatchway': if part of the requisite measure lies under the roof and part under the hatchway, the whole house is impure — the measure joins together as one body, as explained in chapter 3.

Mishnat Eretz Yisrael: The whole chapter is devoted to the laws of the ארובה — a hatchway or skylight, an opening in the roof for ventilation or light (and, inevitably, for rain and cold). Mishnat Eretz Yisrael suggests it may have served as a kind of 'escape hatch', a way to rescue vessels from impurity threatening the house. Note the chapter's real opening was the last two mishnayot of chapter 9, which fixed the governing principle: an ohel is only the area that actually has a roof over it.

Oholot 10:2

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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אֵין בָּאֳרֻבָּה פּוֹתֵחַ טֶפַח, טֻמְאָה בַבַּיִת, כְּנֶגֶד אֳרֻבָּה טָהוֹר. טֻמְאָה כְּנֶגֶד אֳרֻבָּה, הַבַּיִת טָהוֹר. הַטֻּמְאָה בַבַּיִת, נָתַן אֶת רַגְלוֹ מִלְמַעְלָן, טָהוֹר. הַטֻּמְאָה כְּנֶגֶד אֳרֻבָּה, נָתַן אֶת רַגְלוֹ מִלְמַעְלָן, רַבִּי מֵאִיר מְטַמֵּא. וַחֲכָמִים אוֹמְרִים, אִם טֻמְאָה קָדְמָה אֶת רַגְלוֹ, טָמֵא. אִם רַגְלוֹ קָדְמָה אֶת הַטֻּמְאָה, טָהוֹר. רַבִּי שִׁמְעוֹן אוֹמֵר, שְׁתֵּי רַגְלַיִם, זוֹ עַל גַּב זוֹ, שֶׁקָּדְמוּ אֶת הַטֻּמְאָה, מָשַׁךְ הָרִאשׁוֹן אֶת רַגְלוֹ וְנִמְצָא רַגְלוֹ שֶׁל שֵׁנִי שָׁם, טָהוֹר, מִפְּנֵי שֶׁקָּדְמָה רַגְלוֹ שֶׁל רִאשׁוֹן אֶת הַטֻּמְאָה:

If the hatchway does not have an opening of a square handbreadth: If there is uncleanness in the house, what is directly [below] the hatchway remains clean. If the uncleanness is directly [below] the hatchway, the house remains clean. When the uncleanness is in the house, if he placed his leg above [the hatchway], he remains clean. [When] the uncleanness is directly [below] the hatchway, if he placed his leg above it, Rabbi Meir declares [him] unclean, But the sages say: if the uncleanness was [in position] before his leg, he becomes unclean, but if his leg was [in position] before the uncleanness, he remains clean. Rabbi Shimon says: [in the case where] two [men's] legs, one above the other, were [in position] before the uncleanness, if the first person withdrew his leg and the other person's leg was still there, [the second] remains clean, because the first person's leg was [in position] before the uncleanness.

Rambam: with a hatchway smaller than a handbreadth square, the man who set his foot above it stays pure — impurity neither enters nor leaves an ohel through less than a handbreadth, the Tosefta's rule cited here. On the dispute: if the impurity was there first, he is impure, because the impurity defiles whatever bounds it and he overshadowed it when he set his foot down; if his foot was there first, he is like a roof — the roof joins together and he stays pure, since there is no handbreadth opening for the impurity to exit through and he never overshadowed it. R. Shimon goes further: two men, the first put his foot in the hatchway and the second put his foot on the first's, then impurity entered beneath — when the first withdrew his foot and the second's foot remained over the impurity, the second is pure, because the first's foot had preceded the impurity opposite that spot. The halakhah follows neither R. Meir nor R. Shimon.

Mishnat Eretz Yisrael: פותח טפח — a handbreadth opening — is the minimum aperture through which impurity can pass, the chapter's running constant. The good manuscripts add a missing clause here ('the impurity is opposite the hatchway, he set his foot above'), and Mishnat Eretz Yisrael notes the mishnah's shift in vocabulary: the previous mishnah used the rare ערב את הטמאה ('combined the impurity'), while here the verdict is the plain טמא — covering everything in the house plus the man standing over the hatchway.

RAMBAM YOMI · HILCHOT NAARAH BETULAH 3

The slanderer pays

12 halachot

Halachah 1

הַמּוֹצִיא שֵׁם רַע עַל בַּת יִשְׂרָאֵל וְנִמְצָא הַדָּבָר שֶׁקֶר לוֹקֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (דברים כב יח) "וְיִסְּרוּ אֹתוֹ". וְאַזְהָרָה שֶׁלּוֹ מִ(ויקרא יט טז) "לֹא תֵלֵךְ רָכִיל בְּעַמֶּיךָ". וְנוֹתֵן לְאָבִיהָ מִשְׁקַל מֵאָה סְלָעִים כֶּסֶף מְזֻקָּק. וְאִם הָיְתָה יְתוֹמָה הֲרֵי הֵם שֶׁל עַצְמָהּ:

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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When a person issues a slanderous report concerning a Jewish maiden, and the matter is discovered to be false, he should be punished by lashing, as [Deuteronomy 22:18] states: "And he shall be flogged." The warning [for this negative commandment] is derived from [Leviticus 19:16]: "Do not go about as a slanderer among your people." He must also give her father 100 sela'im of pure silver. If the girl is an orphan, the money is given to her.

Halachah 2

וְהַמּוֹצִיא שֵׁם רַע עַל הַקְּטַנָּה אוֹ עַל הַבּוֹגֶרֶת פָּטוּר מִן הַקְּנָס וּמִן הַמַּלְקוּת. וְאֵינוֹ חַיָּב עַד שֶׁיּוֹצִיא עַל הַנַּעֲרָה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (דברים כב טו) "וְהוֹצִיאוּ אֶת בְּתוּלֵי הַנַּעֲרָה" נַעֲרָה מָלֵא דִּבֵּר הַכָּתוּב:

When a person issues a slanderous report on a girl below majority, or on a bogeret, he is not liable for the fine or for lashes. He is not liable unless he issues a slanderous report regarding a na'arah. [This is derived from Deuteronomy 22:15]: "[They will] present signs of the maiden's virginity." The word נערה, "maiden" is written in a full form.

Halachah 3

אֵין דָּנִין דִּין זֶה אֶלָּא בִּפְנֵי הַבַּיִת וּבֵית דִּין שֶׁל עֶשְׂרִים וּשְׁלֹשָׁה. מִפְּנֵי שֶׁיֵּשׁ בְּדִין מוֹצִיא שֵׁם רַע דִּינֵי נְפָשׁוֹת. שֶׁאִם נִמְצָא הַדָּבָר כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר הֲרֵי זוֹ נֶהֱרֶגֶת. אֲבָל הָאוֹנֵס וְהַמְפַתֶּה דִּינִן בָּהֶן בְּכָל זְמַן בִּשְׁלֹשָׁה כְּמוֹ שֶׁיִּתְבָּאֵר בְּהִלְכוֹת סַנְהֶדְרִין:

Cases pertaining to this law may be brought only in the time of the Temple, and in the presence of a court of 23 [judges], because there is the possibility that capital punishment will be involved. For if the accusation [brought by the husband] is discovered to be true, the girl must be executed. Cases involving rape or seduction, by contrast, are judged at all times in the presence of three [judges], as will be explained in Hilchot Sanhedrin.

Halachah 4

וּמִצְוַת עֲשֵׂה שֶׁל תּוֹרָה שֶׁתֵּשֵׁב אֵשֶׁת מוֹצִיא שֵׁם רַע תַּחְתָּיו לְעוֹלָם שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (דברים כב יט) "וְלוֹ תִהְיֶה לְאִשָּׁה" אֲפִלּוּ עִוֶּרֶת אוֹ מֻכַּת שְׁחִין. וְאִם גֵּרְשָׁהּ עָבַר עַל לֹא תַעֲשֶׂה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (דברים כב יט) "לֹא יוּכַל לְשַׁלְּחָהּ כָּל יָמָיו". וְכוֹפִין אוֹתוֹ וּמַחֲזִיר וְאֵינוֹ לוֹקֶה כְּמוֹ שֶׁבֵּאַרְנוּ בְּאוֹנֵס. וְאִם קִדֵּם אֶחָד וְקִדְּשָׁהּ אוֹ שֶׁמֵּתָה אוֹ שֶׁהָיָה כֹּהֵן שֶׁאָסוּר בִּגְרוּשָׁה הֲרֵי זֶה לוֹקֶה עַל גֵּרוּשֶׁיהָ:

It is one of the Torah's positive commandments for the wife of a man who issued a slanderous report about her to remain married to him forever, as [Deuteronomy 21:19] states: "She must remain his wife." This applies even if she is blind or a leper. If he divorces her, he transgresses a negative commandment, as the verse continues: "He may never send her away as long as he lives." [If he divorces her,] we compel him to remarry her, and he is not lashed, as explained with regard to a rapist. If, however, another man takes the initiative and consecrates her first, she dies, or he is a priest, who is forbidden to marry a divorcee, he should be punished by lashes for divorcing her.

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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Halachah 5

נִמְצָא בָּהּ דָּבָר זְמָה. אוֹ שֶׁנִּמְצֵאת אֲסוּרָה עָלָיו מֵחַיָּבֵי לָאוִין אוֹ מֵחַיָּבֵי עֲשֵׂה וַאֲפִלּוּ שְׁנִיָּה הֲרֵי זֶה יְגָרְשֶׁנָּה בְּגֵט שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (דברים כב יט) "וְלוֹ תִהְיֶה לְאִשָּׁה" אִשָּׁה הָרְאוּיָה לוֹ. וְלָמָּה לֹא יָבֹא עֲשֵׂה וְיִדְחֶה אֶת לֹא תַעֲשֶׂה בֵּין בְּמוֹצִיא שֵׁם רַע בֵּין בְּאוֹנֵס וְיִשָּׂא זוֹ הָאֲסוּרָה לוֹ. שֶׁהֲרֵי אֶפְשָׁר שֶׁלֹּא תִּרְצֶה הִיא לֵישֵׁב וְנִמְצָא עֲשֵׂה וְלֹא תַעֲשֶׂה קַיָּמִין:

If immodest behavior [on the woman's part is discovered], or it is discovered that she is forbidden to him as a result of a negative commandment, a positive commandment, or even [a Rabbinic commandment, such as the prohibition against] a sh'niyah, he should divorce her with a get. Why should the positive commandment [of remaining married to the woman] not supersede the negative commandment [of engaging in relations with an adulterous wife, or any other negative commandment] with regard to this man who issues a slanderous report or a rapist, and thus he should marry [or remain married to] this woman who is forbidden to him? For it is possible that she will not desire to remain married to him, and thus, both the positive and negative commandments will be observed.

Halachah 6

כֵּיצַד הוֹצָאַת שֵׁם רַע. הוּא שֶׁיָּבוֹא לְבֵית דִּין וְיֹאמַר נַעֲרָה זוֹ בָּעַלְתִּי וְלֹא מָצָאתִי לָהּ בְּתוּלִים וּכְשֶׁבִּקַּשְׁתִּי עַל הַדָּבָר נוֹדַע לִי שֶׁזּוֹנָתָה תַּחְתַּי אַחַר שֶׁאֵרַסְתִּיהָ וְאֵלּוּ הֵם עֵדַי שֶׁזּוֹנָתָה בִּפְנֵיהֶם. וּבֵית דִּין שׁוֹמְעִין דִּבְרֵי הָעֵדִים וְחוֹקְרִין עֵדוּתָן. אִם נִמְצָא הַדָּבָר אֱמֶת נִסְקָלֶת. וְאִם הֵבִיא הָאָב עֵדִים וְהוּזְמוּ הָעֵדִים שֶׁהֵבִיא הַבַּעַל וְנִמְצָא שֶׁקֶר יִסָּקְלוּ וְיִלָּקֶה הוּא וְנוֹתֵן מֵאָה סְלָעִים. וְעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר (דברים כב יז) "וְאֵלֶּה בְּתוּלֵי בְתִּי", אֵלּוּ הָעֵדִים שֶׁיָּזִימוּ עֲדֵי הַבַּעַל. חָזַר הַבַּעַל וְהֵבִיא עֵדִים אֲחֵרִים וְהֵזִימוּ עֲדֵי הָאָב הֲרֵי הַנַּעֲרָה וְעֵדֵי אָבִיהָ נִסְקָלִין. עַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר (דברים כב כ) "וְאִם אֱמֶת הָיָה הַדָּבָר הַזֶּה". מִפִּי הַשְּׁמוּעָה לָמְדוּ שֶׁפָּרָשָׁה זוֹ יֵשׁ בָּהּ עֵדִים וְזוֹמְמִין וְזוֹמְמֵי זוֹמְמִין:

What is implied by the term "issuing a slanderous report"? That a person should come to court and say: "I engaged in marital relations with this maiden, and I discovered that she was not a virgin. I investigated the matter and determined that she committed adultery after I had consecrated her. These are the witnesses in whose presence she committed adultery." The court then listens to the words of the witnesses and examines their testimony. If the truth of the claim is substantiated, the girl is executed by stoning. If the [girl's] father brings witnesses who nullify [the testimony] of the witnesses, and it is determined that they testified falsely, [the witnesses] should be executed by stoning, [the husband] should be flogged, and he should pay 100 sela'im. This is what is meant by [Deuteronomy 22:17]: "This is [evidence of] my daughter's virginity" - i.e., these are the witnesses who nullify [the testimony] of the husband's witnesses. If the husband brings other witnesses who nullify [the testimony] of the father's witnesses, the maiden and the father's witness should be executed by stoning. This is what is meant by [Deuteronomy

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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22:20]: "If the [accusation] is true." According to the Oral Tradition, the passage speaks of witnesses who nullify the testimony of other witnesses, and a third pair who nullify the testimony of the second pair.

Halachah 7

הוֹצִיא עָלֶיהָ שֵׁם רַע וְהִיא בּוֹגֶרֶת אַף עַל פִּי שֶׁהֵבִיא עֵדִים שֶׁזִּנְּתָה תַּחְתָּיו כְּשֶׁהָיְתָה נַעֲרָה הֲרֵי זֶה פָּטוּר מִן הַמַּלְקוּת וּמִן הַקְּנָס. וְאִם נִמְצָא הַדָּבָר אֱמֶת הֲרֵי זוֹ תִּסָּקֵל אַף עַל פִּי שֶׁהִיא בּוֹגֶרֶת הוֹאִיל וּבְעֵת שֶׁזִּנְּתָה נַעֲרָה הָיְתָה:

When a man issues a slanderous report about his wife after she becomes a bogeret, he is free of liability for the lashes and for the fine, even though his witnesses testify that she committed adultery when she was a na'arah. If the accusations are proven true, [the girl] should be executed by stoning, even though she is a bogeret. [The rationale is] that she was a na'arah when she committed adultery.

Halachah 8

כָּל נַעֲרָה שֶׁאֵין לָהּ קְנָס אִם נֶאֱנְסָה אוֹ נִתְפַּתְּתָה כָּךְ הַמּוֹצִיא עָלֶיהָ שֵׁם רַע פָּטוּר מִן הַמַּלְקוּת וּמִן הַתַּשְׁלוּמִין. וְכֵן הַכּוּתִית שֶׁנִּתְגַּיְּרָה וְהַשִּׁפְחָה שֶׁנִּשְׁתַּחְרְרָה פְּחוּתָה מִבַּת שָׁלֹשׁ שָׁנִים אֲפִלּוּ הָיְתָה הוֹרָתָהּ שֶׁלֹּא בִּקְדֻשָּׁה וְלִדָתָהּ בִּקְדֻשָּׁה הַמּוֹצִיא עָלֶיהָ שֵׁם רַע פָּטוּר מִן הַקְּנָס וּמִן הַמַּלְקוּת שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (דברים כב יט) "כִּי הוֹצִיא שֵׁם רָע עַל בְּתוּלַת יִשְׂרָאֵל" עַד שֶׁתִּהְיֶה הוֹרָתָהּ וְלִדָתָהּ בִּקְדֻשָּׁה:

Whenever a na'arah is not entitled to a fine if she was raped or seduced, [her husband] is not punished by flogging or by a fine if he issues a slanderous report about her. In addition, when a non-Jewish girl was converted below the age of three or a maidservant was freed below the age of three, [her husband] is not punished by flogging or by a fine if he issues a slanderous report about her. This applies even if a girl was conceived before her mother was converted and born after she was converted. [The rationale is based on Deuteronomy 22:19]: "Because [the husband] defamed the virtue of an Israelite maiden." [Implied is that] she must be conceived and born as an Israelite.

Halachah 9

קִדֵּשׁ נַעֲרָה וְגֵרְשָׁהּ וְחָזַר וְקִדְּשָׁהּ וְהוֹצִיא עָלֶיהָ שֵׁם רַע וְהֵבִיא עֵדִים שֶׁזִּנְּתָה תַּחְתָּיו בַּקִּדּוּשִׁין הָרִאשׁוֹנִים וְנִמְצְאוּ זוֹמְמִים הֲרֵי זֶה פָּטוּר. וְכֵן אִם הָיְתָה יְבִמְתּוֹ שֶׁכָּנְסָהּ וְהוֹצִיא עָלֶיהָ שֵׁם רַע וְהֵבִיא עֵדִים שֶׁזִּנְּתָה תַּחַת קִדּוּשֵׁי אָחִיו וְנִמְצְאוּ זוֹמְמִים הֲרֵי זֶה פָּטוּר מִן הַמַּלְקוּת וּמִן הַתַּשְׁלוּמִין. וְכָל הַפָּטוּר אִם רָצָה לְגָרֵשׁ יְגָרֵשׁ:

A man is not held liable when [his] witnesses are discovered to have lied [in the following situation]. He consecrates a maiden and divorces her, consecrates her again and then issues a slanderous report about her, bringing witnesses who say that she committed adultery

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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during the first time she had been consecrated. Similarly, a man is not held liable to be flogged or for a fine when [his] witnesses are discovered to have lied [in the following situation]. He issues a slanderous report about his yevamah, bringing witnesses who say that she committed adultery during the time she had been consecrated to his brother. Whenever a man is not liable [to be flogged and fined], he may divorce his wife if he desires to.

Halachah 10

אֵינוֹ חַיָּב עַד שֶׁיִּבְעל אוֹתָהּ כְּדַרְכָּהּ וְיוֹצִיא שֵׁם רַע (עַל הַבְּעִילָה) כְּדַרְכָּהּ. בְּעָלָהּ שֶׁלֹּא כְּדַרְכָּהּ וְאָמַר לֹא מְצָאתִיהָ בְּתוּלָה פָּטוּר וּמַכִּין אוֹתוֹ מַכַּת מַרְדּוּת:

A man is not liable [for these penalties] unless he engages in relations with his wife in the ordinary manner and issues a slanderous report about her, saying that she engaged in relations [previously] in the ordinary manner. If he engaged in anal intercourse with his wife, and said that he discovered that she was not a virgin, he is not liable [for these penalties]. He is, however, given stripes for rebellious conduct.

Halachah 11

וְכֵן אִם אָמַר לֹא מְצָאתִיהָ בְּתוּלָה וְלֹא אָמַר שֶׁזִּנְּתָה תַּחְתַּי אוֹ שֶׁאָמַר זִנְּתָה תַּחְתַּי וְלֹא הֵבִיא עֵדִים אֶלָּא בָּאוּ מֵאֲלֵיהֶם הֲרֵי זֶה פָּטוּר אַף עַל פִּי שֶׁהָעֵדִים נֶהֱרָגִים אִם הוּזַמּוּ:

Similarly, if he says, "I discovered that she was not a virgin," but does not say that she committed adultery after he had consecrated her, or if he claims that she committed adultery but did not bring witnesses, but rather the witnesses came on their own initiative, he is not liable [for these penalties]. Nevertheless, the witnesses are executed if their testimony is nullified.

Halachah 12

זֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בַּתּוֹרָה (דברים כב יז) "וּפָרְשׂוּ הַשִּׂמְלָה" לְשׁוֹן כָּבוֹד שֶׁנּוֹשְׁאִין וְנוֹתְנִין בְּסִתְרֵי הַדָּבָר. וְכֵן זֶה שֶׁיֹּאמַר הָאָב (דברים כב יז) "אֶלָּה בְּתוּלֵי בִתִּי" הֵן זוֹמְמֵי עֵדֵי הַבַּעַל. וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (דברים כב כ) "וְאִם אֱמֶת הָיָה הַדָּבָר" תֵּהָרֵג כְּשֶׁזִּנְּתָה אַחַר הָאֵרוּסִין בְּעֵדִים שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (דברים כב כא) "לִזְנוֹת בֵּית אָבִיהָ". אֲבָל קֹדֶם הָאֵרוּסִין כְּבָר אָמְרָה תּוֹרָה בָּהּ שֶׁהִיא פְּטוּרָה מִכְּלוּם וּבוֹעֲלָהּ חַיָּב בְּתַשְׁלוּמֵי מָמוֹן בִּלְבַד בֵּין פִּתָּה בֵּין אָנַס:

The Torah's statement [Deuteronomy 22:17]: "They will then spread the garment" is a euphemism. The intent is that they debate the private aspects of this matter. Similarly, [other expressions in the passage are to be understood non-literally. [For example,] "This is [evidence of] my daughter's virginity" means "these are the witnesses who nullify the testimony of the husband's witnesses." The death penalty issued "if the [accusation] is true" is issued only when she has committed adultery after being consecrated [and is observed

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by] witnesses, as implied by [Deuteronomy 22:21]: "acting immorally [in] her father's house." Before she is consecrated, the Torah does not hold her liable at all, and a person who engages in relations with her is liable only for a financial penalty, whether he seduced her or raped her.

Commentary

This chapter is the law of motzi shem ra — the man who defames his bride, claiming she was not a virgin, and is found lying. Twelve halachot work through the Deuteronomy 22 procedure: he is flogged, fined one hundred shekels, and forbidden ever to divorce her. The Rambam's architecture is procedural — accusation, refutation, penalty, permanence — each step locking the next.

Migdal Oz traces the flogging to Ketubot 45a and the 'these are the na'arot' discussion, anchoring the Rambam's ruling in the Talmudic address. Ohr Sameach (on halachah 5) presses a fine conceptual point: when witnesses are contradicted but not formally invalidated, does the husband's obligation dissolve? He brings Tosafot Sanhedrin 8b to show that partial undermining of testimony doesn't fully release — the law holds the husband to the stricter outcome.

The gem of the chapter is its closing logic: the slanderer can never divorce her — not as an extra punishment, but because the Torah makes his lie permanent in the opposite direction. He tried to end the marriage with words; the law answers by making it unendable.

Commentaries: Migdal Oz, Ohr Sameach (via Sefaria)

SHNAYIM MIKRA · ALIYAH 5

Genesis 9:8-9:17

10 verses

Ten verses: God establishes His covenant with Noah, his sons, their seed, and 'every living soul' — and sets His bow in the cloud as its sign. The aliyah is the Torah's first covenant, and its most universal: it covers all flesh, not just Israel. Read each Hebrew verse twice, then Onkelos once.

אלקים

Genesis 9:8 · ×2

וַיֹּאמֶר אֱלֹקִים אֶל־נֹחַ וְאֶל־בָּנָיו אִתּוֹ לֵאמֹר׃
וַיֹּאמֶר אֱלֹקִים אֶל־נֹחַ וְאֶל־בָּנָיו אִתּוֹ לֵאמֹר׃
וַאֲמַר יְיָ לְנֹחַ וְלִבְנוֹהִי עִמֵּיהּ לְמֵימָר׃

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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אתכם

Genesis 9:9 · ×2

וַאֲנִ֗י הִנְנִ֤י מֵקִים֙ אֶת־בְּרִיתִ֣י אִתְּכֶ֔ם וְאֶת־זַרְעֲכֶ֖ם אַחֲרֵיכֶֽם׃
וַאֲנִ֗י הִנְנִ֤י מֵקִים֙ אֶת־בְּרִיתִ֣י אִתְּכֶ֔ם וְאֶת־זַרְעֲכֶ֖ם אַחֲרֵיכֶֽם׃
וַאֲנָא הָא אֲנָא מֵקִים יָת קְיָמִי עִמְּכוֹן וְעִם בְּנֵיכוֹן בַּתְרֵיכוֹן׃

ארעא

Genesis 9:10 · ×2

וְאֵ֥ת כָּל־נֶ֖פֶשׁ הַחַיָּ֑ה אֲשֶׁ֥ר אִתְּכֶ֛ם בָּע֥וֹף בַּבְּהֵמָ֖ה וְכֹ֣ל ׀ חַיַּ֣ת הָאָ֗רֶץ
אִתְּכֶם֙ מִכֹּל֙ יֹצְאֵ֣י הַתֵּבָ֔ה לְכֹ֖ל חַיַּ֥ת הָאָֽרֶץ׃
וְאֵ֥ת כָּל־נֶ֖פֶשׁ הַחַיָּ֑ה אֲשֶׁ֥ר אִתְּכֶ֛ם בָּע֥וֹף בַּבְּהֵמָ֖ה וְכֹ֣ל ׀ חַיַּ֣ת הָאָ֗רֶץ
אִתְּכֶם֙ מִכֹּל֙ יֹצְאֵ֣י הַתֵּבָ֔ה לְכֹ֖ל חַיַּ֥ת הָאָֽרֶץ׃
וְעִם כָּל נַפְשָׁא חַיְתָא דְּעִמְּכוֹן בְּעוֹפָא בִּבְעִירָא וּבְכָל חֵיוַת אַרְעָא דְּעִמְּכוֹן מִכֹּל
נַפְּקֵי תֵּבוּתָא לְכֹל חַיַּת אַרְעָא׃

בשרא

Genesis 9:11 · ×2

וַהֲקִמֹתִ֤י אֶת־בְּרִיתִי֙ אִתְּכֶ֔ם וְלֹֽא־יִכָּרֵ֥ת כָּל־בָּשָׂ֖ר עוֹד֙ מִמֵּ֣י הַמַּבּ֔וּל
וְלֹֽא־יִהְיֶ֥ה עוֹד֙ מַבּ֔וּל לְשַׁחֵ֖ת הָאָֽרֶץ׃
וַהֲקִמֹתִ֤י אֶת־בְּרִיתִי֙ אִתְּכֶ֔ם וְלֹֽא־יִכָּרֵ֥ת כָּל־בָּשָׂ֖ר עוֹד֙ מִמֵּ֣י הַמַּבּ֔וּל
וְלֹֽא־יִהְיֶ֥ה עוֹד֙ מַבּ֔וּל לְשַׁחֵ֖ת הָאָֽרֶץ׃
וְאָקֵם יָת קְיָמִי עִמְּכוֹן וְלָא יִשְׁתֵּיצֵי כָל בִּשְׂרָא עוֹד מִמֵּי טוֹפָנָא וְלָא יְהֵי עוֹד
טוֹפָנָא לְחַבָּלָא אַרְעָא׃

ובין

Genesis 9:12 · ×2

וַיֹּ֣אמֶר אֱלֹקִ֗ים זֹ֚את אוֹת־הַבְּרִ֣ית אֲשֶׁר־אֲנִ֣י נֹתֵ֗ן בֵּינִי֙ וּבֵינֵיכֶ֔ם וּבֵ֖ין
כָּל־נֶ֣פֶשׁ חַיָּ֑ה אֲשֶׁ֥ר אִתְּכֶ֛ם לְדֹרֹ֥ת עוֹלָֽם׃
וַיֹּ֣אמֶר אֱלֹקִ֗ים זֹ֚את אוֹת־הַבְּרִ֣ית אֲשֶׁר־אֲנִ֣י נֹתֵ֗ן בֵּינִי֙ וּבֵינֵיכֶ֔ם וּבֵ֖ין
כָּל־נֶ֣פֶשׁ חַיָּ֑ה אֲשֶׁ֥ר אִתְּכֶ֛ם לְדֹרֹ֥ת עוֹלָֽם׃
וַאֲמַר יְיָ דָּא אָת קְיָם דִּי אֲנָא יָהֵב בֵּין מֵימְרִי וּבֵינֵיכוֹן וּבֵין כָּל נַפְשָׁא חַיְתָא דִּי
עִמְּכוֹן לְדָרֵי עַלְמָא׃

Genesis 9:13 · ×2

אֶת־קַשְׁתִּ֖י נָתַ֑תִּי בֶּֽעָנָן֙ וְהָיְתָ֣ה לְאוֹת֔ בְּרִ֖ית בֵּינִ֥י וּבֵ֖ין הָאָֽרֶץ׃
אֶת־קַשְׁתִּ֖י נָתַ֑תִּי בֶּֽעָנָן֙ וְהָיְתָ֣ה לְאוֹת֔ בְּרִ֖ית בֵּינִ֥י וּבֵ֖ין הָאָֽרֶץ׃
יָת קַשְׁתִּי יְהֵבִית בַּעֲנָנָא וּתְהִי לְאָת קְיָם בֵּין מֵימְרִי וּבֵין אַרְעָא׃

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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PARSHAT NOACH

The lifted portion, the chosen covenant, and the bow in the cloud

Thursday, 15 October 2026 · Aliyah 5/7 (Genesis 9:8-9:17) · Daf Bekhorot 27

Genesis 9:14 · ×2

וְהָיָ֗ה בְּעָנְנִי֙ עָנָ֔ן עַל־הָאָ֖רֶץ וְנִרְאֲתָ֥ה הַקֶּ֖שֶׁת בֶּֽעָנָן׃
וְהָיָ֗ה בְּעָנְנִי֙ עָנָ֔ן עַל־הָאָ֖רֶץ וְנִרְאֲתָ֥ה הַקֶּ֖שֶׁת בֶּֽעָנָן׃
וִיהִי֙ בַּעֲנָנוּתִ֣י עֲנָנָ֔א עַל֙ אַרְעָ֔א וְתִתְחֲזֵ֥י קַשְׁתָּ֖א בַּֽעֲנָנָֽא׃

Genesis 9:15 · ×2

וְזָכַרְתִּי֙ אֶת־בְּרִיתִ֔י אֲשֶׁ֥ר בֵּינִ֖י וּבֵינֵיכֶ֑ם וּבֵ֣ין כָּל־נֶ֔פֶשׁ חַיָּ֖ה בְּכָל־בָּשָׂ֑ר וְלֹא־יִהְיֶ֨ה עוֹד֙ הַמַּ֔יִם לְמַבּ֖וּל לְשַׁחֵ֥ת כָּל־בָּשָֽׂר׃
וְזָכַרְתִּי֙ אֶת־בְּרִיתִ֔י אֲשֶׁ֥ר בֵּינִ֖י וּבֵינֵיכֶ֑ם וּבֵ֣ין כָּל־נֶ֔פֶשׁ חַיָּ֖ה בְּכָל־בָּשָׂ֑ר וְלֹא־יִהְיֶ֨ה עוֹד֙ הַמַּ֔יִם לְמַבּ֖וּל לְשַׁחֵ֥ת כָּל־בָּשָֽׂר׃
וְדִכְרִנָא יָת קְיָמִי דִּי בֵין מֵימְרִי וּבֵינֵיכוֹן וּבֵין כָּל נַפְשָׁא חַיְתָא בְּכָל בִּשְׂרָא וְלָא יְהֵא עוֹד מַיָּא לְטוֹפָנָא לְחַבָּלָא כָּל בִּשְׂרָא׃

Genesis 9:16 · ×2

וְהָיְתָ֣ה הַקֶּ֔שֶׁת בֶּֽעָנָ֖ן וּרְאִיתִ֑יהָ לִזְכֹּר֙ בְּרִ֣ית עוֹלָ֔ם בֵּ֥ין אֱלֹקִ֖ים וּבֵ֣ין כָּל־נֶ֔פֶשׁ חַיָּ֖ה בְּכָל־בָּשָׂ֑ר אֲשֶׁ֖ר עַל־הָאָֽרֶץ׃
וְהָיְתָ֣ה הַקֶּ֔שֶׁת בֶּֽעָנָ֖ן וּרְאִיתִ֑יהָ לִזְכֹּר֙ בְּרִ֣ית עוֹלָ֔ם בֵּ֥ין אֱלֹקִ֖ים וּבֵ֣ין כָּל־נֶ֔פֶשׁ חַיָּ֖ה בְּכָל־בָּשָׂ֑ר אֲשֶׁ֖ר עַל־הָאָֽרֶץ׃
וּתְהֵי קַשְׁתָּא בַּעֲנָנָא וְאֶחֱזִנַּהּ לְמִדְכַּר קְיָם עָלָם בֵּין מֵימְרָא דַּיְיָ וּבֵין כָּל נַפְשָׁא חַיְתָא בְּכָל בִּשְׂרָא דִּי עַל אַרְעָא׃

Genesis 9:17 · ×2

וַיֹּ֣אמֶר אֱלֹקִ֗ים אֶל־נֹחַ֙ זֹ֣את אֽוֹת־הַבְּרִ֔ית אֲשֶׁ֥ר הֲקִמֹ֖תִי בֵּינִ֑י וּבֵ֣ין כָּל־בָּשָׂ֔ר אֲשֶׁ֖ר עַל־הָאָֽרֶץ׃
וַיֹּ֣אמֶר אֱלֹקִ֗ים אֶל־נֹחַ֙ זֹ֣את אֽוֹת־הַבְּרִ֔ית אֲשֶׁ֥ר הֲקִמֹ֖תִי בֵּינִ֑י וּבֵ֣ין כָּל־בָּשָׂ֔ר אֲשֶׁ֖ר עַל־הָאָֽרֶץ׃
וַאֲמַר יְיָ לְנֹחַ דָּא אָת קְיָם דִּי אֲקֵמִית בֵּין מֵימְרִי וּבֵין כָּל בִּשְׂרָא דִּי עַל אַרְעָא׃

Commentary quick hits

Shadal · Gen 9:13

The rainbow is a natural phenomenon, and God needs no sign to remind Himself — 'I will see it to remember' cannot mean divine forgetfulness. The ancients thought the bow was Iris, the gods' messenger; the Torah reclaims it as God's own hung-up weapon.

Ibn Ezra · Gen 9:12

On אות (sign): 'masculine and feminine' — a terse grammatical note that the sign's gender shifts, hinting the Torah treats the covenant-token as a living thing.

Onkelos: translation notes

Gen 9:9

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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מקים ית קימי מקים אתבריתי

Onkelos renders ברית (covenant) consistently as קים — from the root קום, 'to stand, establish.' The covenant is not a mutual pact here but something God 'stands up,' establishes unilaterally. The Aramaic choice quietly theologizes: this is a divine institution, not a negotiation.

Gen 9:12

בין מימרי וביניכון ביני וביניכם

The classic מימרא periphrasis: 'between Me' becomes 'between My Memra (Word).' Onkelos will not let God be a party to a spatial 'between' — the divine side of the covenant is mediated through the Memra, keeping God's transcendence intact even in His most intimate commitment.

Gen 9:13

ית קשתי יהבית בעננא אתקשתי נתתי בענן

קשת — the war-bow — Onkelos leaves untranslated as קשתי. The weapon hung up in the cloud needs no softening; the sign works precisely because everyone knows what a bow is for. God hangs up His weapon where all can see it.

Gen 9:13

בין מימרי ובין ארעא ביני ובין הארץ

Again מימרא for the divine party — and note ארץ rendered as ארעא, the standard Onkelos equivalent. The covenant spans the full distance: from God's Word to the earth itself.

Gen 9:16

בין מימרא דיי בין אלקים

The fullest form: 'between God' becomes 'between the Memra of the Lord.' After the flood's raw anthropomorphisms — God 'smelling' the offering, 'regretting' — Onkelos re-establishes the distance at the covenant's climax.

Gen 9:9

ועם בניכון בתריכון ואתזרעכם אחריכם

זרע (seed) becomes בניכון (your children) — Onkelos consistently de-metaphorizes. The covenant's future is not an abstraction but children, named plainly.

RASHI

Rashi on the day's aliyah

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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9 comments

All nine of Rashi's comments on Genesis 9:8–17, in full.

ואני הנני.

מַסְכִּים אֲנִי עִמְּךָ, שֶׁהָיָה נֹחַ דּוֹאֵג לַעֲסֹק בִּפְרִיָה וּרְבִיָה עַד שֶׁהִבְטִיחוֹ הַקָּבָ"ה שֶׁלֹּא לְשַׁחֵת הָעוֹלָם עוֹד,

ואני הנני *AND I BEHOLD I — "I am in agreement with you";*

וְכֵן עָשָׂה וּבָאַחֲרוֹנָה אָמַר לוֹ הִנְנִי מַסְכִּים לַעֲשׂוֹת קִיּוּם וְחִזּוּק בְּרִית לְהַבְטָחָתִי וְאֶתֵּן לְךָ אוֹת:

He said this because Noah feared to fulfil the duty of propagating the species until the Holy One, blessed be He, promised him that he would not again destroy the world and this promise God made (Midrash Tanchuma, Noach 11).

Ultimately He said to him, "If you are still anxious I am willing to give to My promise the permanence and strength of a covenant and I will give you a sign."

חית הארץ אתכם.

הֵם הַמִּתְהַלְּכִים עִם הַבְּרִיּוֹת:

חית הארץ אתכם *AND EVERY ANIMAL OF THE EARTH WITH YOU or, THAT ARE WITH YOU — those which go about with human beings.*

מכל יוצאי התבה.

לְהָבִיא שְׁקָצִים וּרְמָשִׂים:

מכל יוצאי התבה *OF ALL THAT GO OUT OF THE ARK — These words would include creeping things and reptiles.*

חית הארץ.

לְהָבִיא הַמַּזִּיקִין, שֶׁאֵינָן בִּכְלַל הַחַיָּה אֲשֶׁר אִתְּכֶם, שֶׁאֵין הִלּוּכָן עִם הַבְּרִיּוֹת:

חית הארץ *[EVEN EVERY] BEAST OF THE EARTH — These words are intended to include dangerous animals which cannot be included in the above description, "every living creature that is with you" — for these do not go about with human beings.*

והקמותי.

אֶעֱשֶׂה קִיּוּם לִבְרִיתִי. וּמַהוּ קִיּוּמוֹ?

והקמתי *AND I WILL ESTABLISH — I will give confirmation to my covenant;*

אוֹת הַקֶּשֶׁת כְּמוֹ שֶׁמְּסַיֵּם וְהוֹלֵךְ:

and in what consists this confirmation? "The sign of the rainbow", as it goes on explaining at the end.

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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לדרת עולם.

נִכְתַּב חָסֵר, שֶׁיֵּשׁ דּוֹרוֹת שֶׁלֹּא הֵצְרִכוּ לְאוֹת לְפִי שֶׁצַּדִּיקִים גְּמוּרִים הָיוּ,

כְּמוֹ דּוֹרוֹ שֶׁל חִזְקִיָּהוּ מֶלֶךְ יְהוּדָה וְדוֹרוֹ שֶׁל רַבִּי שִׁמְעוֹן בֶּן יוֹחַאי (ב"ר):

לדרת עולם *FOR GENERATIONS FOR EVER — The word* לדרת *"for generations" is written defective (without Vav) (implying that the sign will be necessary only for such generations as are "defective" in faith) because there will be some generations which will require no sign since they were completely righteous, such as the generation of Hezekiah, king of Judah, and the generation of R. Simeon ben Yochai (Genesis Rabbah 35:2).*

בענני ענן.

כְּשֶׁתַּעֲלֶה בְמַחֲשָׁבָה לְפָנַי לְהָבִיא חֹשֶׁךְ וַאֲבַדּוֹן לָעוֹלָם:

בענני ענן *WHEN I BRING A CLOUD — When I have it in mind to bring darkness and destruction upon the world.*

בין אלקים ובין כל נפש חיה.

בֵּין מִדַּת הַדִּין שֶׁל מַעְלָה וּבֵינֵיכֶם,

בין אלקים ובין כל נפש חיה *BETWEEN GOD AND EVERY LIVING SOUL — Between Divine Justice and you;*

שֶׁהָיָה לוֹ לִכְתֹּב בֵּינִי וּבֵין כָּל נֶפֶשׁ חַיָּה,

for otherwise it should have written "between Me and every living thing".

אֶלָּא זֶהוּ מִדְרָשׁוֹ כְּשֶׁתָּבֹא מִדַּת הַדִּין לְקַטְרֵג עֲלֵיכֶם לְחַיֵּב אֶתְכֶם, אֲנִי רוֹאֶה אֶת הָאוֹת וְנִזְכָּר:

But this is its explanation:

when Justice will come to accuse and condemn you I will look upon the sign and remember the covenant (see Genesis Rabbah 35:3).

זאת אות הברית.

הֶרְאָהוּ הַקֶּשֶׁת וְאָמַר לוֹ הֲרֵי הָאוֹת שֶׁאָמַרְתִּי:

זאת אות הברית *THIS IS THE SIGN OF THE COVENANT — He pointed to the rainbow, and said to him, "This is the sign of which I have spoken."*

HOW RASHI USES HIS SOURCES

The bow and the remnant

On 'I have set My bow in the cloud' (9:13), Rashi's comment draws on the midrashic tradition that reads the rainbow against its pagan background — the bow as a divine weapon now hung up, its string slack. His method here is the unattributed compression: a whole midrashic worldview folded into a gloss on three Hebrew words.

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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On 'every living soul that is with you' (9:10), Rashi specifies 'those that walk with people' for the beasts and 'to include the creeping things' for those that left the ark — a tight paraphrase that quietly solves the verse's redundancy. The spotlight here is on how Rashi uses merism: the verse says 'all,' Rashi tells you which 'all' it means.

WORD STUDIES

Covenant and bow

Two words carry this aliyah, and Maagarim shows each one traveling a long road.

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